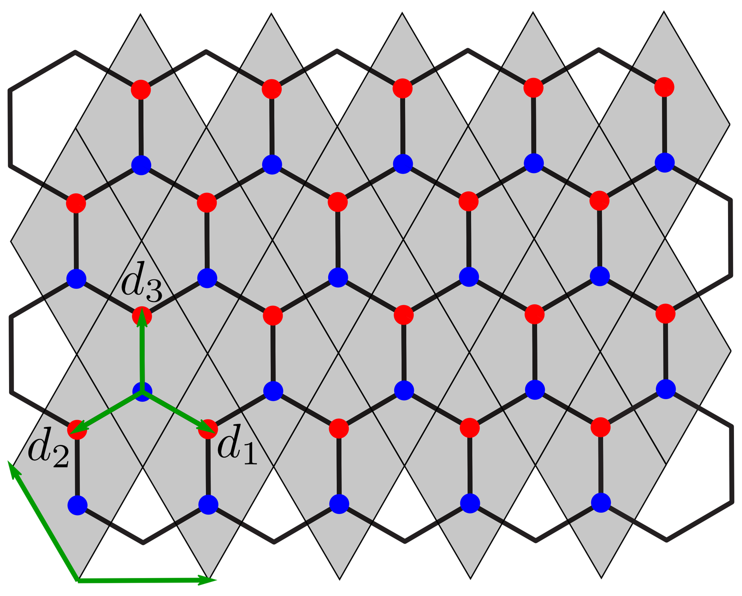
# Curvature and Torsion in the Continuum Theory of Lattice Defects

Marvin Henke, Dr. Nikodem Szpak
Faculty of Physics, University of Duisburg-Essen

UNIVERSITÄT DUISBURG ESSEN

*Offen im Denken*

## Continuum Theory - Graphene[1]




### Tight-binding Hamiltonian

$$H = \sum_{\vec{r}} \sum_{j=1}^{3} \left( a^\dagger_{\vec{r}} b_{\vec{r}+\vec{d}_j} + b^\dagger_{\vec{r}+\vec{d}_j} a_{\vec{r}} \right)$$

### Fourier transform

$$i\partial_t \vec{\psi}(\vec{k}) = \boldsymbol{h}(\vec{k}) \vec{\psi}(\vec{k})$$

$$\boldsymbol{h}(\vec{k}) = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & f(\vec{k}) \\ f^*(\vec{k}) & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad f(\vec{k}) = \sum_{j=1}^{3} e^{i\vec{k}\cdot\vec{d}_j}$$

### Linear dispersion around Dirac points

$$\vec{k} = \vec{K}^{(s)} + \delta\vec{k} \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \boldsymbol{h}(\vec{k}) \approx -\frac{3}{2}\delta\vec{k}\cdot\vec{\boldsymbol{\sigma}}$$

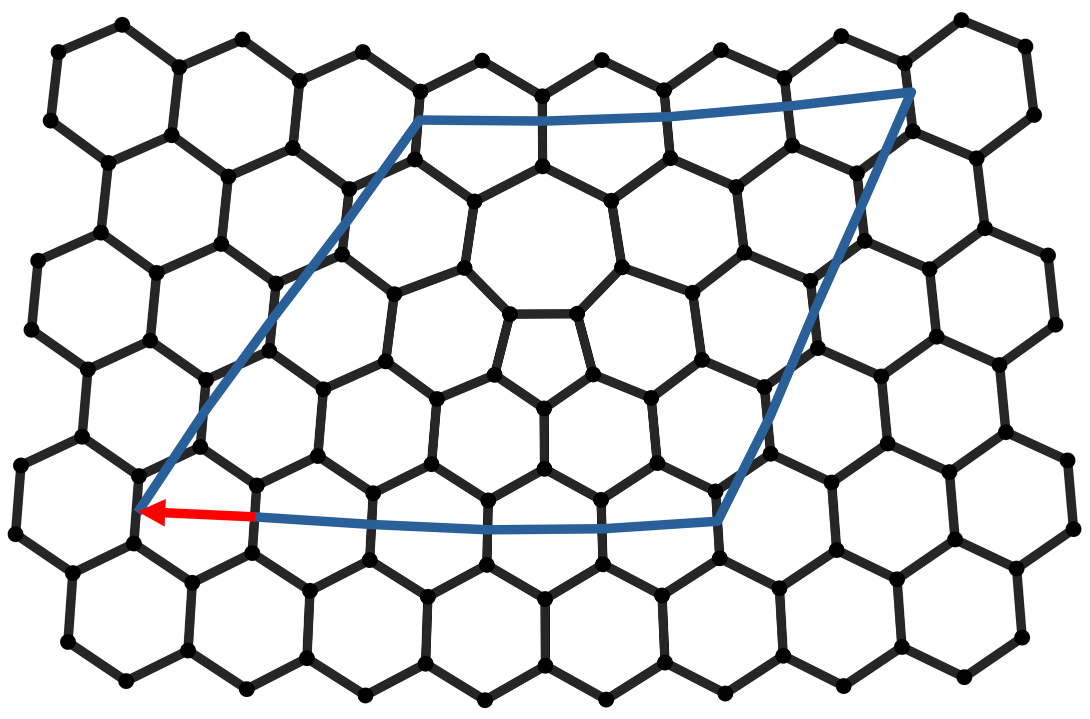
### Continuum limit

$$i\partial_t \vec{\phi}(\vec{r}) = i\, c\, \boldsymbol{\sigma}^i \partial_i \vec{\phi}(\vec{r}), \qquad \rho = \vec{\phi}^\dagger \vec{\phi}, \qquad \vec{j} = -c\vec{\phi}^\dagger \vec{\boldsymbol{\sigma}} \vec{\phi}$$

$$\Updownarrow$$

$$i\gamma^\mu \partial_\mu \phi = 0, \quad \gamma^\mu = \sigma^\mu \sigma^3, \quad \mu \in \{0,1,2\}$$

## Burgers vector for a 5-7 defect[2]



→ **Lattice dislocation** with Burgers vector:

$$\vec{b} = -\sqrt{3}\,\vec{u}_x$$

## Torsion[3]

→ Standard GR: torsion vanishes
→ Torsion = **antisymmetric** part of the connection

$$T^\lambda{}_{\mu\nu} = \Gamma^\lambda{}_{\mu\nu} - \Gamma^\lambda{}_{\nu\mu}$$

→ Decomposition of any general affine connection into symmetric part, contorsion & disformation:

$$\Gamma^\alpha{}_{\mu\nu} = \{^\alpha{}_{\mu\nu}\} + K^\alpha{}_{\mu\nu} + L^\alpha{}_{\mu\nu}$$

→ **Metric-compatibility**:

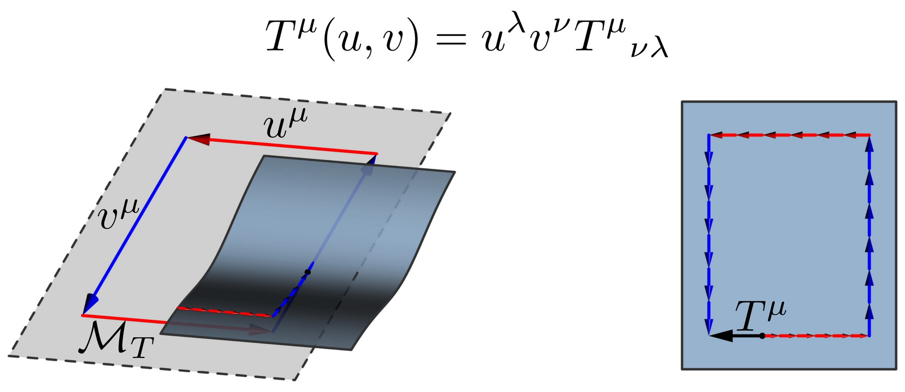
$$\nabla_\lambda g_{\mu\nu} = 0 \Leftrightarrow L^\alpha{}_{\mu\nu} = 0$$

→ **Contorsion tensor** from torsion:

$$K^\alpha{}_{\mu\nu} = \frac{1}{2}\left(T^\alpha{}_{\mu\nu} - T_{\mu\nu}{}^\alpha + T_\nu{}^\alpha{}_\mu\right)$$

→ **Visual** idea: displacement vector $T^\mu(u,v)$ when rolling tangent plane along parallelogram:

$$T^\mu(u,v) = u^\lambda v^\nu T^\mu{}_{\nu\lambda}$$

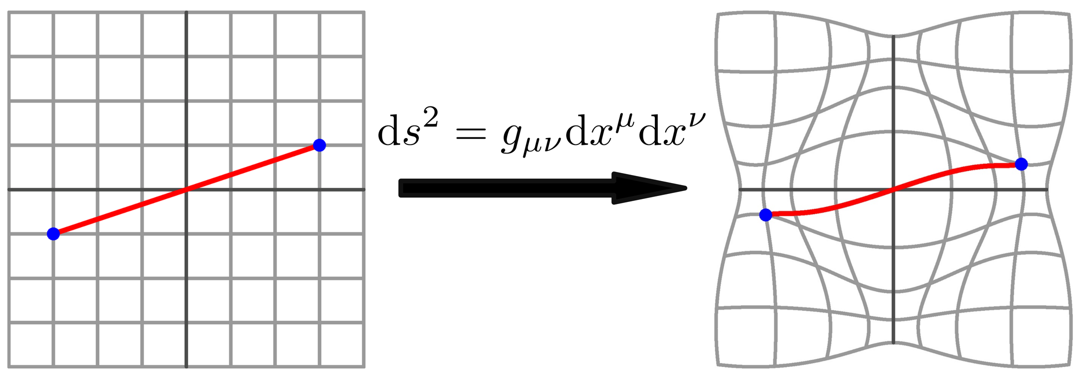



## Riemannian Geometry[3]

→ Riemannian **manifold** $\mathcal{M}$ with metric $g_{\mu\nu}$ and connection $\Gamma^\lambda{}_{\mu\nu}$

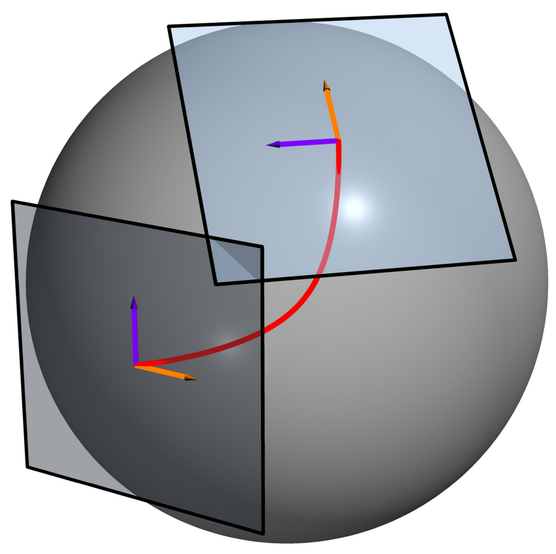
### Metric

→ Defines distances & angles on manifold




### Connection

→ Connectes nearby **tangent spaces**
→ Allows definition of **tensorial** derivative
→ Unique torsion-free, metric-compatible connection:
**Levi-Civita connection**



$$\{^\lambda_{\mu\nu}\} = \frac{1}{2} g^{\lambda\rho}\left(\partial_\nu g_{\rho\mu} + \partial_\mu g_{\rho\nu} - \partial_\rho g_{\mu\nu}\right)$$

### Covariant derivative

→ Takes into account the **structure** of the manifold
→ Transforms like a **tensor**

$$\nabla_\mu v^\nu = \partial_\mu v^\nu + \Gamma^\nu{}_{\mu\lambda} v^\lambda$$

### Autoparallels

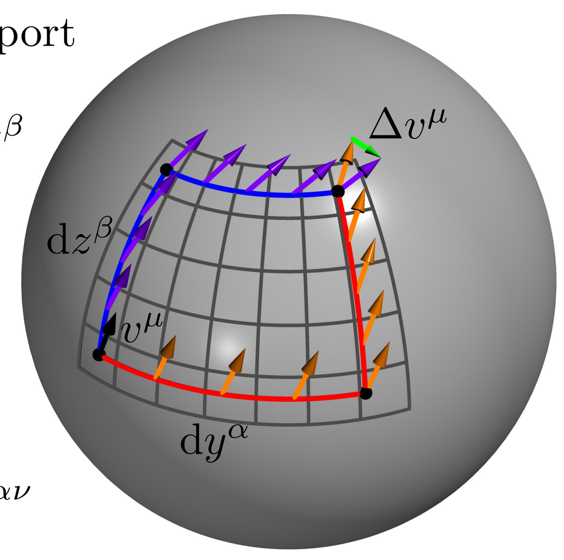
→ Tangent vector is parallel-transported

$$u^\mu \nabla_\mu u^\alpha = 0$$

### Curvature

→ how does parallel transport depend on the path?
→ $\Delta v^\mu = R_{\alpha\beta}{}^\mu{}_\nu\, v^\nu\, \mathrm{d}y^\alpha\, \mathrm{d}z^\beta$
→ Fully determined by the connection:

$$R_{\alpha\beta}{}^\mu{}_\nu = + \partial_\alpha \Gamma^\mu{}_{\beta\nu} - \partial_\beta \Gamma^\mu{}_{\alpha\nu} + \Gamma^\mu{}_{\alpha\lambda}\Gamma^\lambda{}_{\beta\nu} - \Gamma^\mu{}_{\beta\lambda}\Gamma^\lambda{}_{\alpha\nu}$$




## Metric ↔ torsion mapping in 2D

→ Physical mapping between:
⟶ **Classical** Manifold $\mathcal{M}_g(g_{ij}, \{^k_{ij}\})$
⟶ **Purely torsionful** Manifold $\mathcal{M}_T(\delta_{ij}, K^k{}_{ij}\})$
→ Coordinate choice: $g_{\mu\nu} = \delta_{\mu\nu}\, e^{2\phi(x,y)}$.
→ Antisymmetry: $T^k{}_{ij} = b^k \varepsilon_{ij}$
→ Demand equal **curvature** of both manifolds:

$$R\left[\mathcal{M}_g\right] = R\left[\mathcal{M}_T\right],$$

→ leads to solution for torsion vector $b^i$ as function of metric $\phi$ and arbitrary scalar field $\chi$:

$$b^i = \varepsilon_{ik}\, \partial_k \phi + \partial_i \chi$$

→ for $\chi = 0$: **autoparallels** of both manifolds equivalent up to reparameterization
→ $\chi$ corresponds to local roatations of the frame field

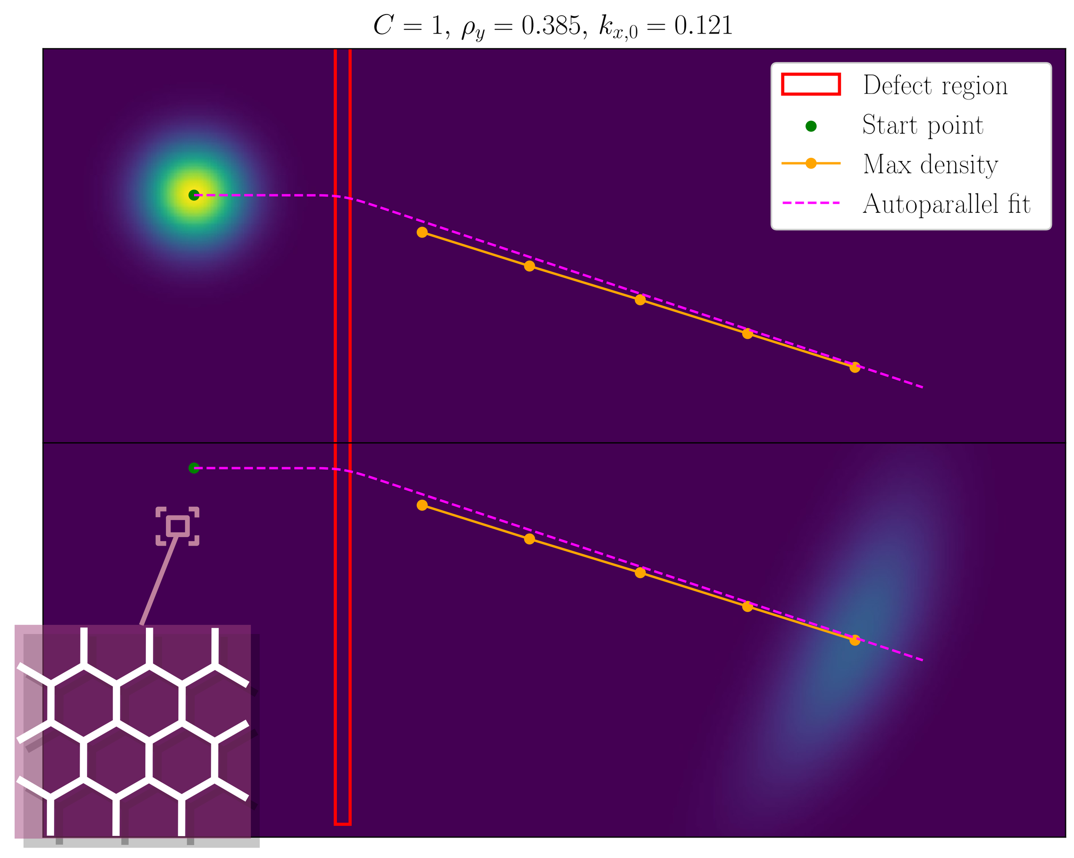
### Conclusion

→ Autoparallels and curvature can be mapped
→ Different distance measure
→ Other tangent spaces and tensors

## Tight-binding numerics

→ **vector representation** of wavefunction at discrete lattice sites
→ Hamiltonian is (sparse) **Matrix** acting on this vector to generate time evolution:

$$i\partial_t \vec{\psi} = H\vec{\psi} \quad \Rightarrow \quad \vec{\psi}(t) = e^{-iHt}\vec{\psi}_0$$




## Torsion model

→ $\mathcal{M}_T$ with $b^1(x)$ and $b^2 \equiv 0$
→ Autoparallel equation:

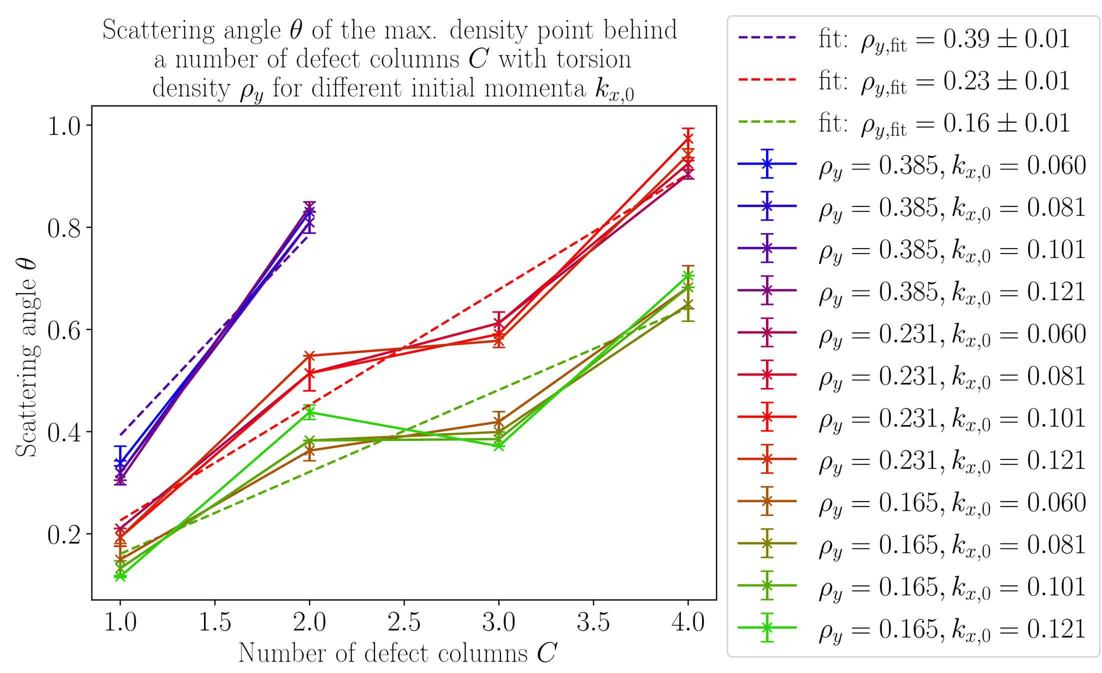
$$\ddot{x} = -\dot{x}\dot{y}b^1, \quad \ddot{y} = \dot{x}^2 b^1$$

→ Allows calculating the scattering angle:

$$\theta_T = \int b^1(x)\,\mathrm{d}x$$

→ Interpreting torsion as Burgers vector density:

$$\rho_y = (\vec{b})_x/\Delta y \approx \frac{\iint b^1 \mathrm{d}x\mathrm{d}y}{\Delta y} = \int b^1 \mathrm{d}x = \theta_T$$




## Outlook

The classical Dirac equation obtained from continuum theory of graphene can be generalized to describe **curved graphene** by simple generalization to a non-flat geometry[1]. The problem is, that this mechanism only works for a torsionless geometry. For a geometry with torsion, which is used to model the scattering with autoparallels, the Lagrangian needs to be constructed in a way that preserves **hermiticity**[4]. The question is whether the dynamics resulting from this Lagrangian can describe the tight-binding results.

## References

[1] Stegmann T, Szpak N. Current flow paths in deformed graphene. *New J. Phys.* **18**, 053016 (2016).
[2] Bhatt MD, Kim H, Kim G. Various defects in graphene: a review. *RSC Adv.* **12**, 21520 (2022).
[3] Heisenberg L. A systematic approach to generalisations of General Relativity. *Phys. Rep.* **796**, 1 (2019).
[4] de Juan F, Cortijo A, Vozmediano MAH. Dislocations and torsion in graphene. *Nucl. Phys. B* **828**, 625 (2010).